Adverbs of frequency

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Say how often we do things (con qué frecuencia)
- Learn always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely and never
- Put the adverb in the right place in the sentence
- Ask and answer How often...? with once, twice and every

Para pensar

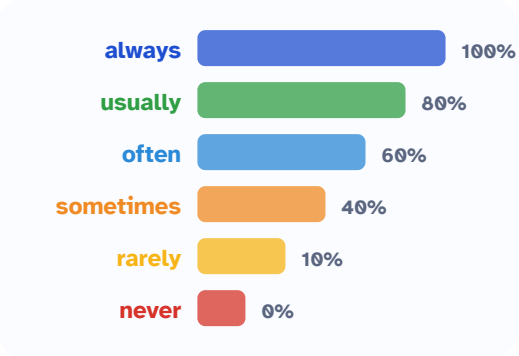
¿Te lavas los dientes todos los días? ¿Comes brócoli de vez en cuando? ¿Has subido a un camello alguna vez? ¿Cómo dirías en inglés con qué frecuencia haces algo?

Explicación

How often?

Adverbs of frequency tell us **how often** something happens. We use them with the **present simple** to talk about routines and habits: «I **always** have breakfast at eight.» «My cat **never** drinks milk.» «We **sometimes** go to the cinema.»

Imagine a scale from 100% to 0%. At the top is **always**, the thing you do every single time. At the bottom is **never**, the thing you don't do at all. In the middle there are other words. **En castellano:** son palabras como «siempre», «a menudo» o «nunca».



Six adverbs

Let's learn them with examples. **always** (siempre, 100%): «I always wear a seatbelt in the car.» **usually** (normalmente, 80%): «I usually walk to school.» **often** (a menudo, 60%): «We often play basketball at break.»

sometimes (a veces, 40%): «My dad sometimes cooks pizza.» **rarely** or **hardly ever** (casi nunca, 10%): «I rarely watch the news.» **never** (nunca, 0%): «Penguins never fly.» **Pronunciación:** *often* se dice «ófen» (la t casi no suena) y *usually*, «iúshuali».



Where does the adverb go?

The position is important. Adverbs of frequency go before the main verb: «I **always get up** at seven.» «She **often reads** comics.» «They **never eat** meat.»

But with the verb to be, they go **after** it: «I **am always** hungry after PE.» «My brother **is never** late.» «We **are usually** tired on Fridays.» **Truco:** «antes del verbo de acción, después de *be*». En castellano tenemos más libertad, por eso es un error típico.

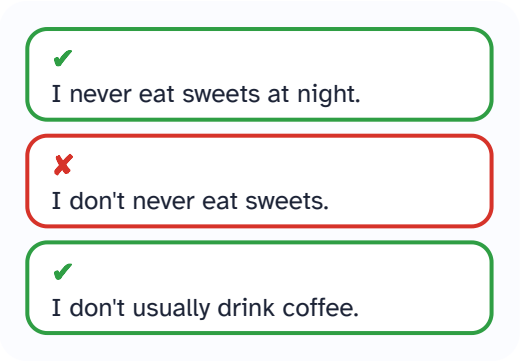


Before the verb, after be.

Sometimes and negatives

Sometimes is special: it can also go at the **beginning** or the **end** of the sentence. «**Sometimes** I go by bike.» «I go by bike **sometimes**.»

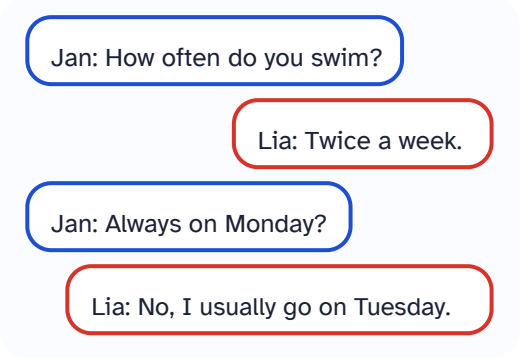
Never is already negative, so we don't use *don't* with it. ✔ «I **never** eat sweets at night.» ✘ «I don't never eat...». In negative sentences we can use **don't usually** or **don't often**: «I **don't usually** drink coffee» (normalmente no tomo café). **En castellano:** decimos «no como nunca», pero en inglés solo hay una negación.



Questions: How often...?

To ask about frequency we say How often...? + do/does: «**How often do** you go swimming?» «**How often does** your sister play the violin?»

We can answer with an adverb: «I **sometimes** go swimming.» Or with an expression of frequency: «**Once a week**» (una vez a la semana). «**Twice a month**» (dos veces al mes). «**Three times a year**» (tres veces al año). «**Every day**» (todos los días). «**Every Saturday**».



Once, twice, every...

Expressions of frequency are more exact than adverbs. **once** = one time; **twice** = two times; then **three times**, **four times**... + **a day / a week / a month / a year**.

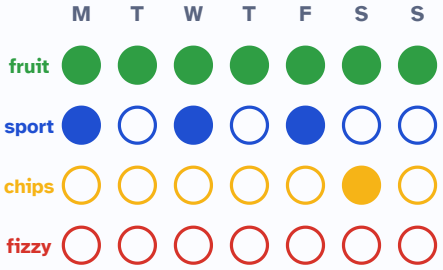
We can also use every: **every day**, **every morning**, **every weekend**, **every summer**. These expressions usually go at the **end** of the sentence: «I have English **three times a week**.» «We visit my aunt **every Christmas**.» «I go to the dentist **twice a year**.»

English	Español
once a week	una vez a la semana
twice a month	dos veces al mes
three times a day	tres veces al día
every weekend	cada fin de semana

Healthy routines

Adverbs of frequency are perfect to talk about **habits**. Are your habits healthy? «I **always** wash my hands before lunch.» «I **usually** sleep nine or ten hours.» «I **often** eat fruit.» «I **sometimes** eat chips.» «I **rarely** drink fizzy drinks.» «I **never** go to bed after eleven.»

Look at your week. Is there something you want to do **more often**? Something you want to do **less often**? Writing your routine in English helps you practise and think about your health at the same time.



fruit: always · sport: often · chips: rarely

Reading: a busy family

Read Joel's text: «My family is very busy. My mum is a nurse, so she **often** works at night. My dad **always** makes breakfast and takes us to school. My sister Clara plays the trumpet. She practises **every day**, and our neighbours are **sometimes** angry! I play football **twice a week**. On Sundays we **usually** visit my grandparents. We **never** watch TV at lunch because we talk. We **rarely** eat out, but **once a month** we have a pizza night.»

How often does Joel play football? Who always makes breakfast? What do they never do?

Dad	always makes breakfast
Clara	practises every day
Joel	football twice a week
Family	never TV at lunch

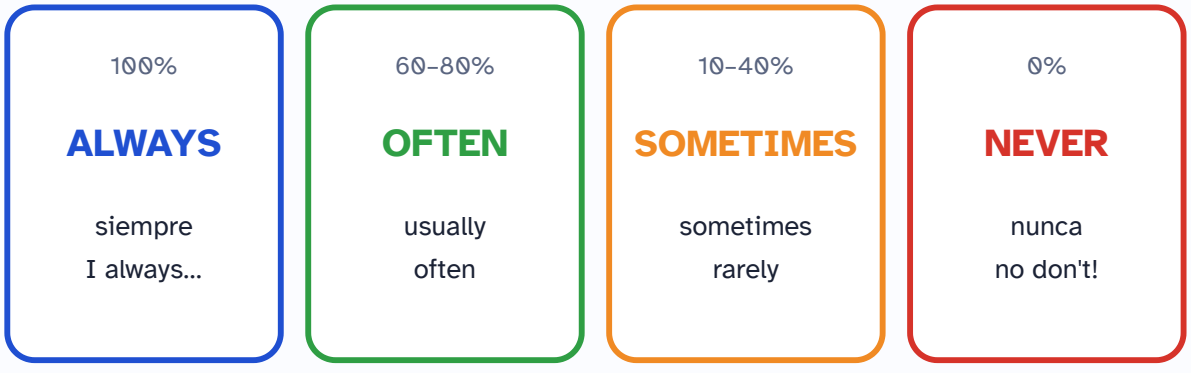
Let's practise: class survey

Make a class survey. Prepare five questions with **How often...?**: «How often do you read a book?», «How often do you eat vegetables?», «How often do you play video games?» Ask five classmates and write their answers in a table.

Then report the results: «Three people **always** eat vegetables. Two people **rarely** read books. Everybody plays video games **sometimes**!» **Repaso:** el adverbio va antes del verbo y después de *be*; *never* no lleva *don't*; las expresiones como *twice a week* van al final.

How often...?	Ana	Biel
read a book	often	rarely
eat veggies	always	usually
play games	sometimes	every day

Adverbs of frequency



Ejercicios

1. **Order from 100% to 0%: sometimes, never, always, often, usually, rarely.**

2. **Put the adverb in place: «We go to the park.» (often)**

3. **Put the adverb in place: «They are noisy.» (sometimes)**

4. **Correct: «He watches never TV.»**

5. **Translate: «Normalmente desayuno cereales.»**

6. **Write in English: «una vez al mes».**

7. **Make the question: «___ ___ do you play tennis?» — «Once a week.»**

8. **Correct: «I don't never eat fish.»**

9. **Write a sentence with «every Sunday».**

10. **Write four sentences about your routine with four different adverbs.**

Practica

1. **«Always» means...**

   A) nunca
   B) a veces
   C) siempre

2. **«Never» means...**

   A) nunca
   B) a menudo
   C) casi siempre

3. **Which adverb is about 40%?**

   A) usually
   B) sometimes
   C) always

4. **Which sentence is correct?**

   A) I walk usually to school.
   B) I usually walk to school.
   C) Usually I walk usually.

5. **Which sentence is correct?**

   A) She often is tired.
   B) Often she tired.
   C) She is often tired.

6. **«___ do you go swimming?» — «Twice a week.»**

   A) How often
   B) How many
   C) When often

7. **«Twice» means...**

   A) one time
   B) every time
   C) two times

8. **«I ___ eat meat.» (vegetarian)**

   A) don't never

B) never

C) always

9. **«Rarely» is similar to...**

A) hardly ever

B) usually

C) often

10. **«He ___ plays chess.»**

A) sometimes

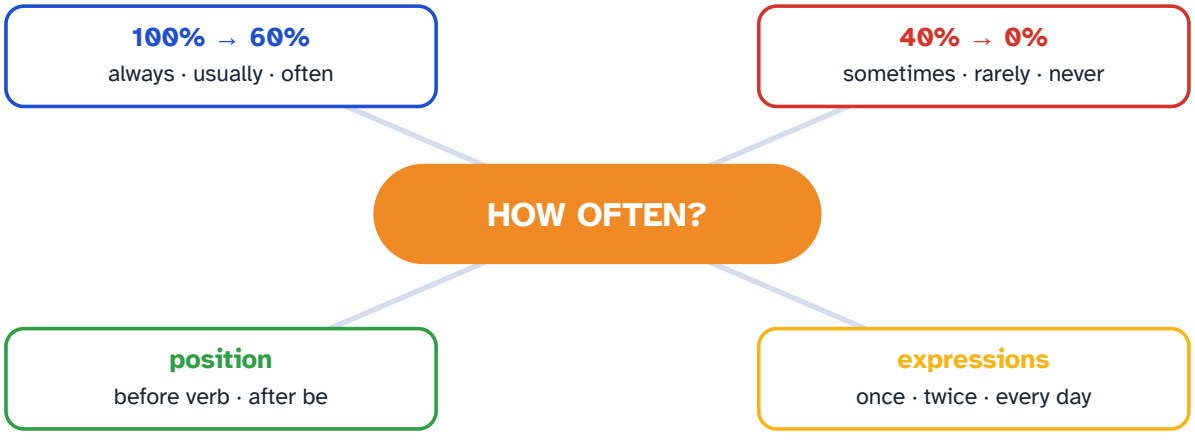
B) sometime

C) some times

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué son los adverbios de frecuencia y su escala; Dónde se colocan en la frase con un verbo de acción y con to be; Por qué never no lleva don't; Cómo se pregunta y se responde con How often.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

always

Siempre (100 %).

usually

Normalmente.

often

A menudo.

sometimes

A veces.

rarely / hardly ever

Casi nunca.

never

Nunca (sin don't).

How often...?

¿Con qué frecuencia...?

once / twice

Una vez / dos veces.

Soluciones

1. **C)** 100 %.
2. **A)** 0 %.
3. **B)** A veces.
4. **B)** Antes del verbo.
5. **C)** Con be, después.
6. **A)** Pregunta de frecuencia.
7. **C)** Dos veces.
8. **B)** Never sin don't.
9. **A)** Casi nunca.
10. **A)** Sometimes, junto.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never.
2. We often go to the park.
3. They are sometimes noisy. (También: Sometimes they are noisy.)
4. He never watches TV.
5. I usually have cereal for breakfast.
6. once a month.
7. How often.
8. I never eat fish.
9. Model answer: We visit my grandma every Sunday.
10. Model answer: I always brush my teeth. I usually walk to school. I sometimes read comics. I never eat chips for breakfast.